

The Fundamentals of Strategy

Joel Tosi

Slides - <https://signalsandlevers.com/StrategyPrDC>



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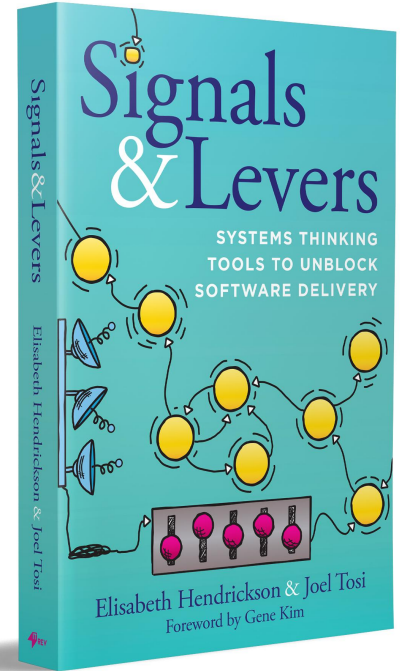
About Us



Joel Tosi



Elisabeth Hendrickson



AVAILABLE NOW!

How Do You Win?



Strategy Requires Choice

1 Option?

2 Options?

3 Options
(Or More)

How Do You Find Options?

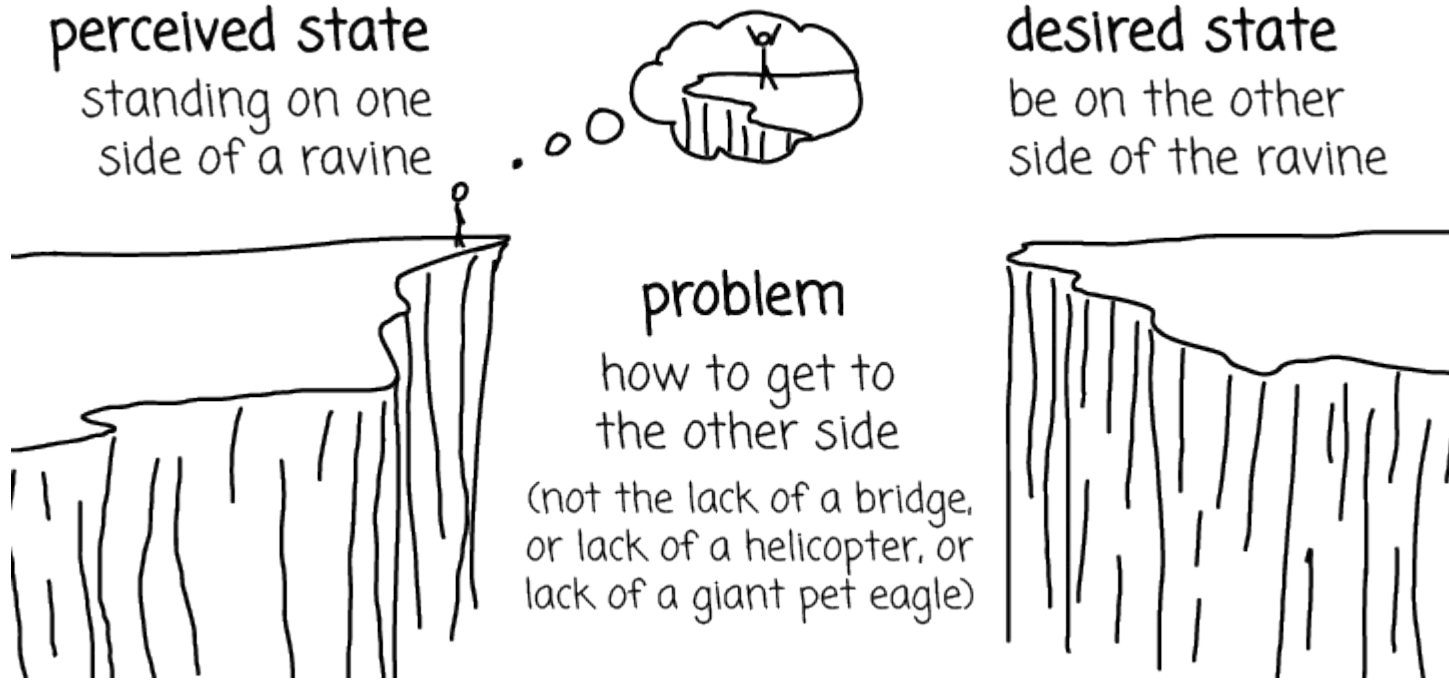
Get To The Core Problem

Understand Current Context

Find Paths

Get To The Core Problem

Problem, Not Solution



How Does The Problem Change?

We aren't in the cloud

Provisioning takes a long time

We are on old technology

Our tech stack is expensive

We have a monolith

Changes have ripple effects

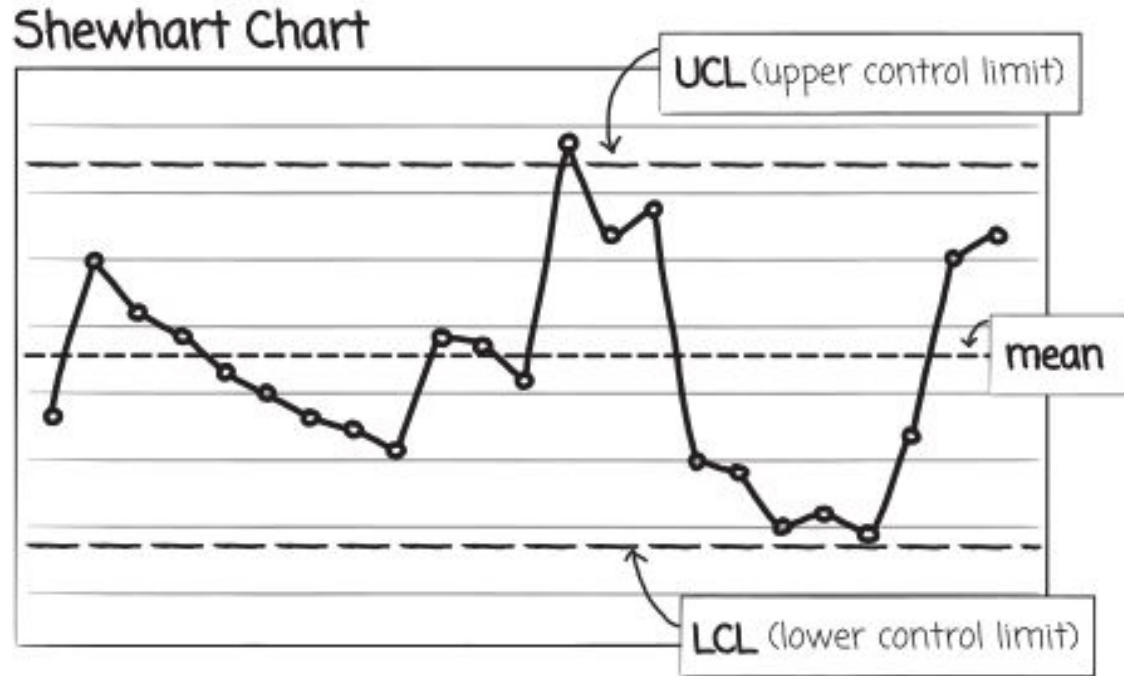
We aren't product oriented

Difficult to be innovative / impact



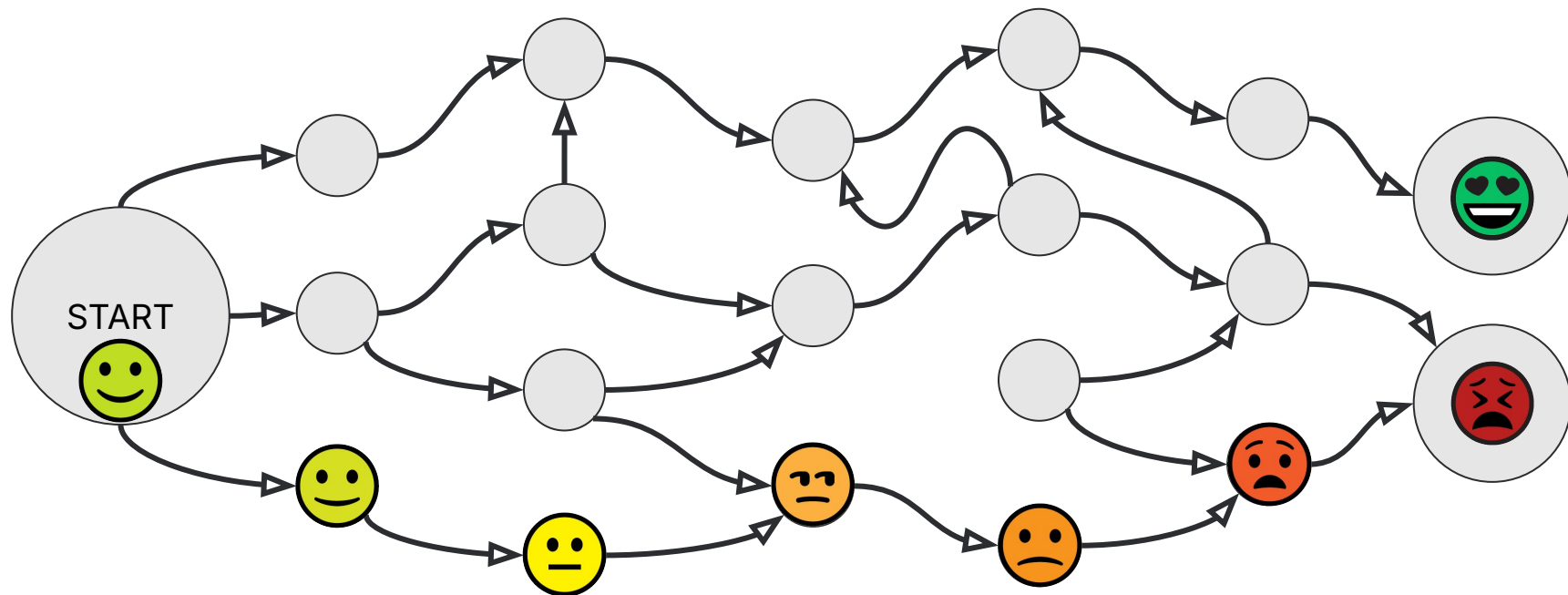
A Word of Caution

Don't React to Noise...



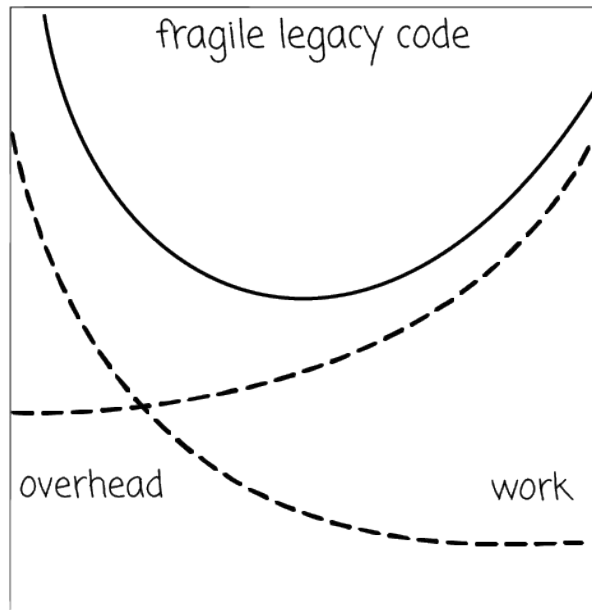
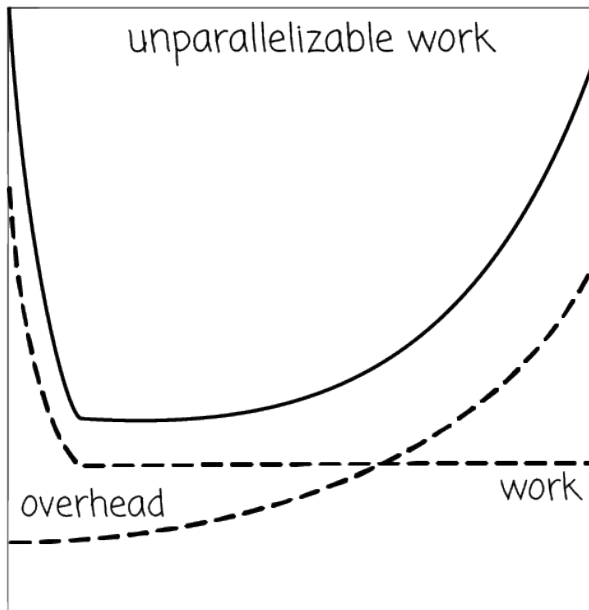
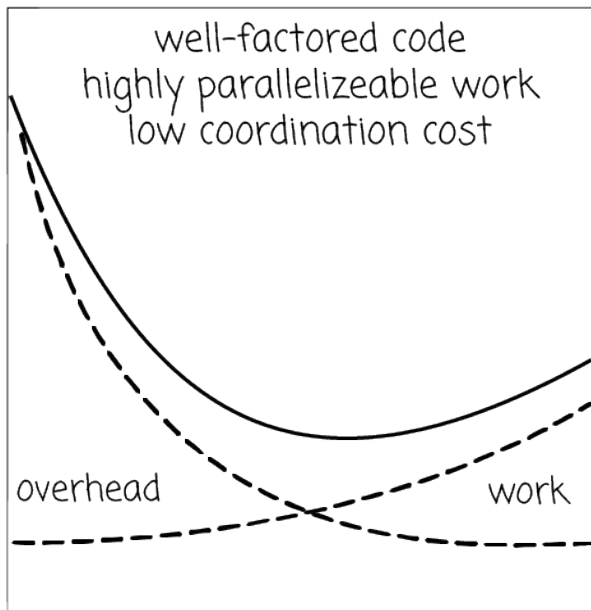
Understand Current Context

Think of your context like a board game...



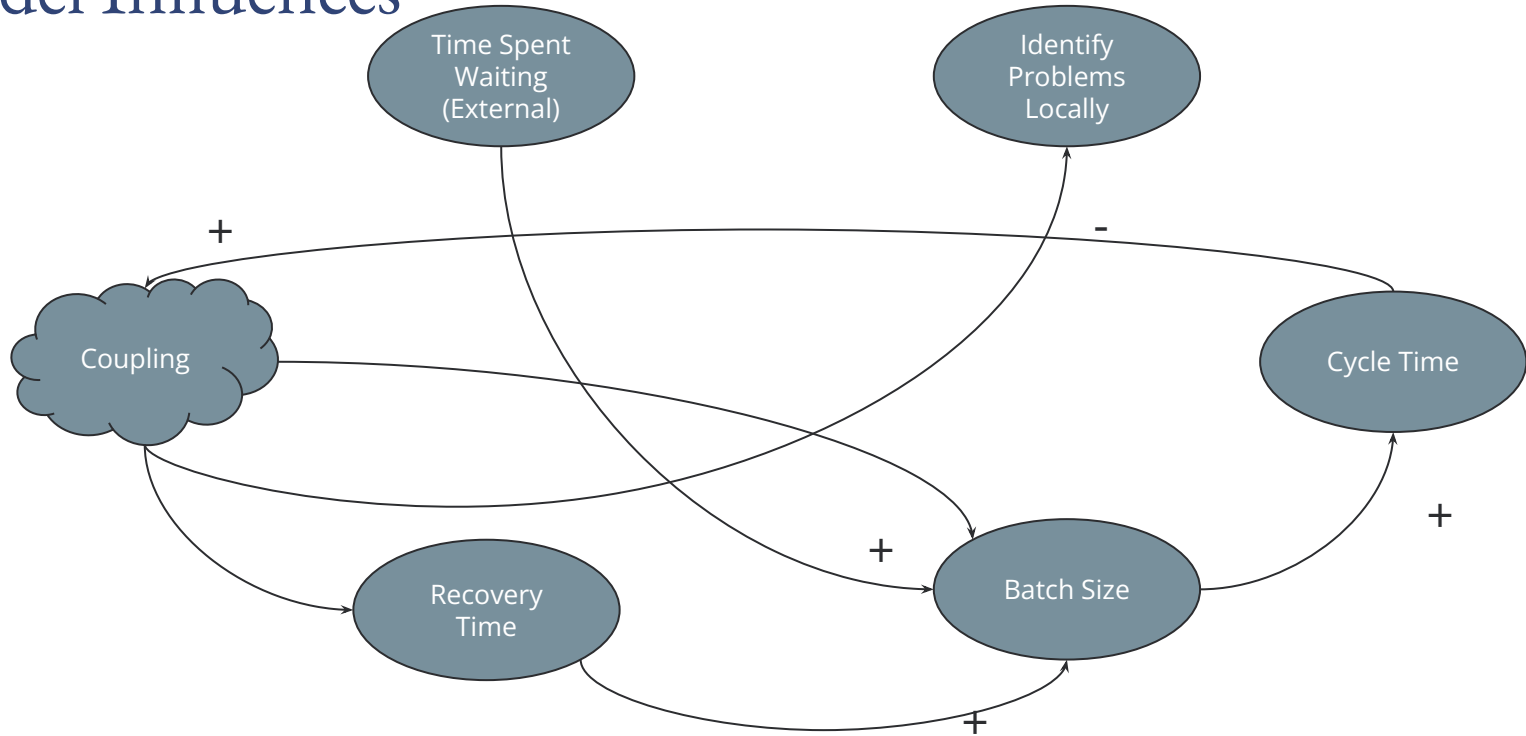
...past choices determine current options.

Understand Your Context Together

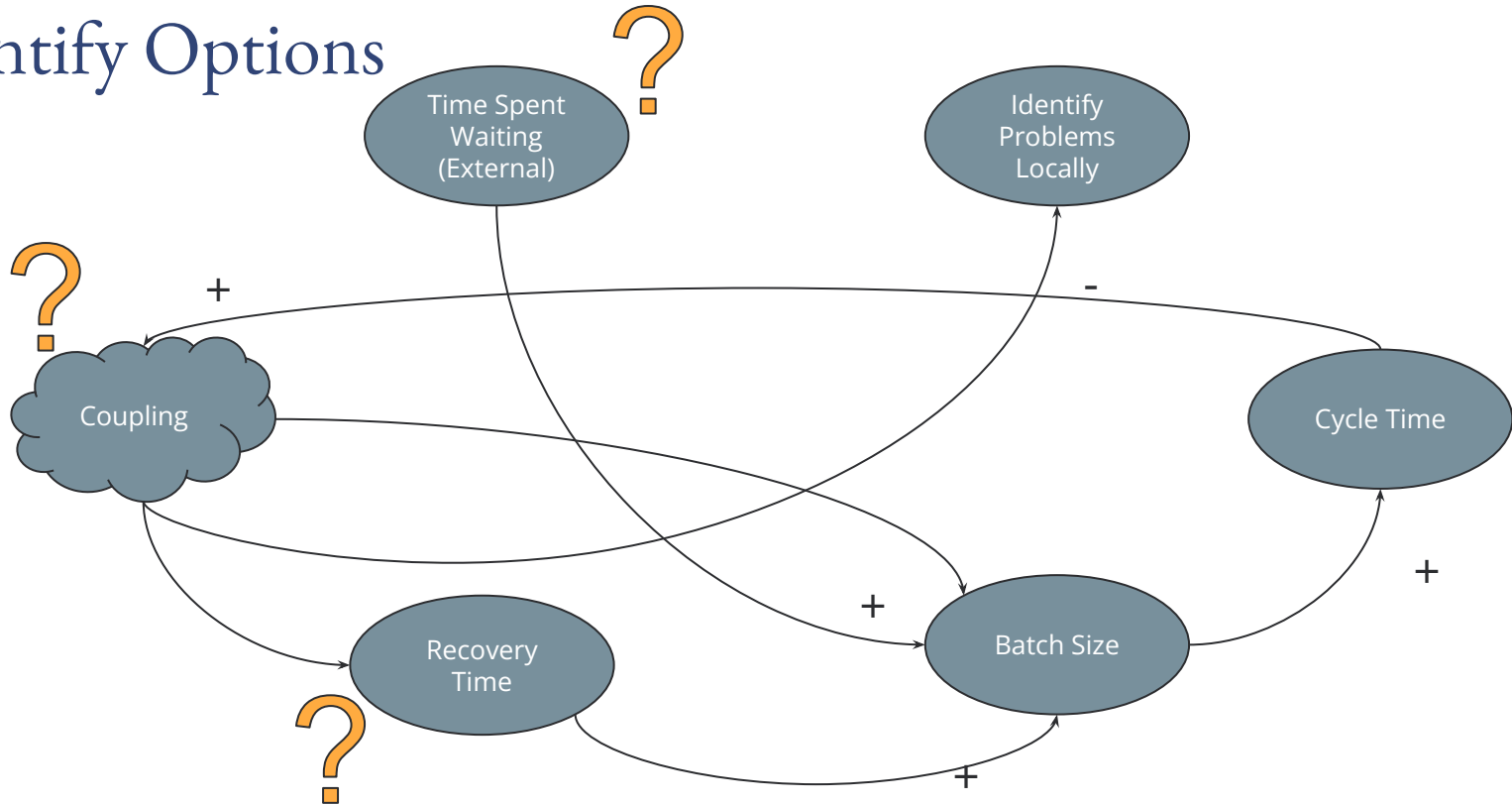


Find Paths

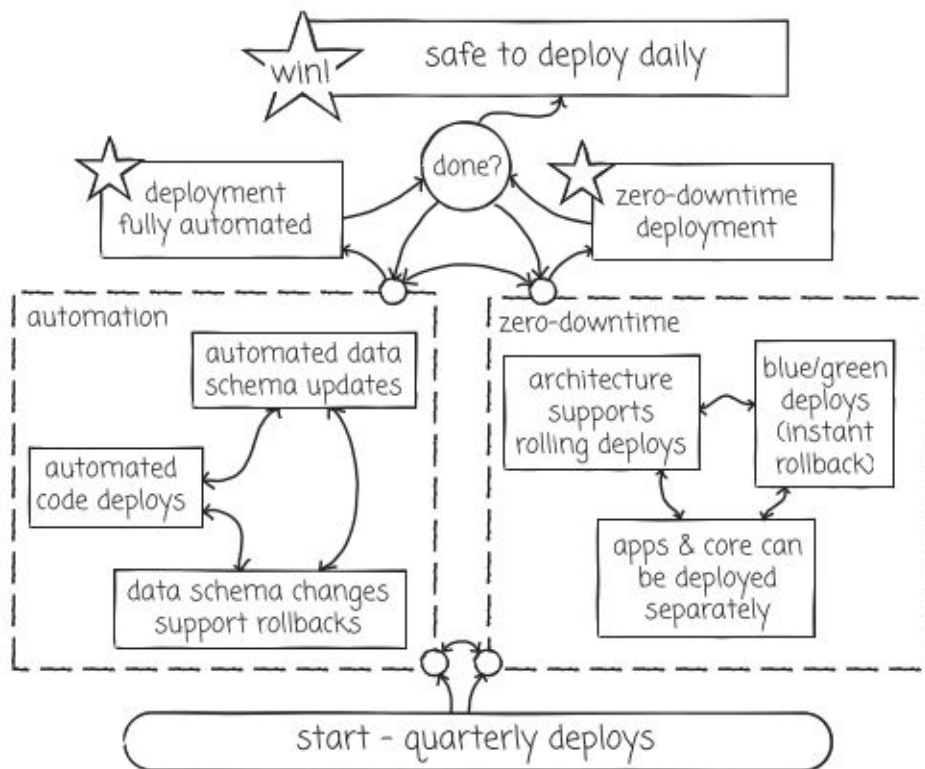
Model Influences



Identify Options



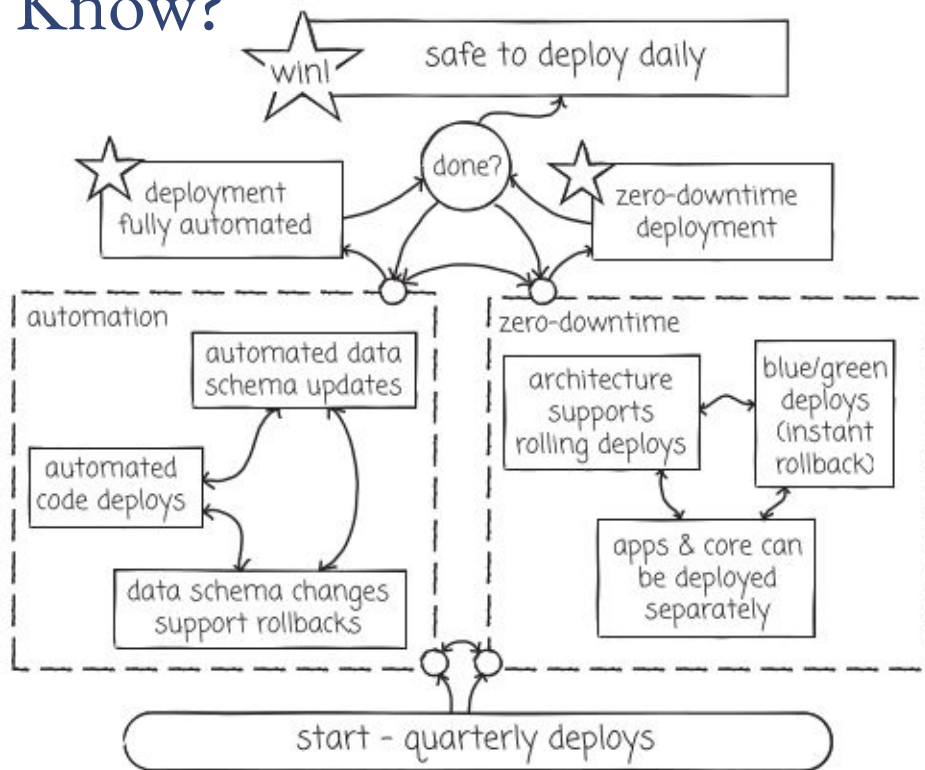
See Paths



Your Problems Are Not
Unique, Your Context Is

Learn Quickly

How Will You Know?



Common Examples of Latency

- Planning Horizons
- Multiple Step 'Process'
- Applying New Skills
- Skill Isolation / Dependencies
- Understanding New Work
- Work Spanning Time Zones
- Customer Feedback
- Separating Learning from Doing
- Support Tiers
- Team Bonding
- Quality Gates (QA, PR Reviews)
- Trust

Which ones can we directly influence?

Dimensions of Context: The CREATE Model

Capacity: how much can we do?

Risk: what is the likelihood of incidents or failures?

Execution: how do we work?

Adaptability: how quickly can we change course?

Trust: how do people treat each other?

Economics: how much does it cost or what will it make?

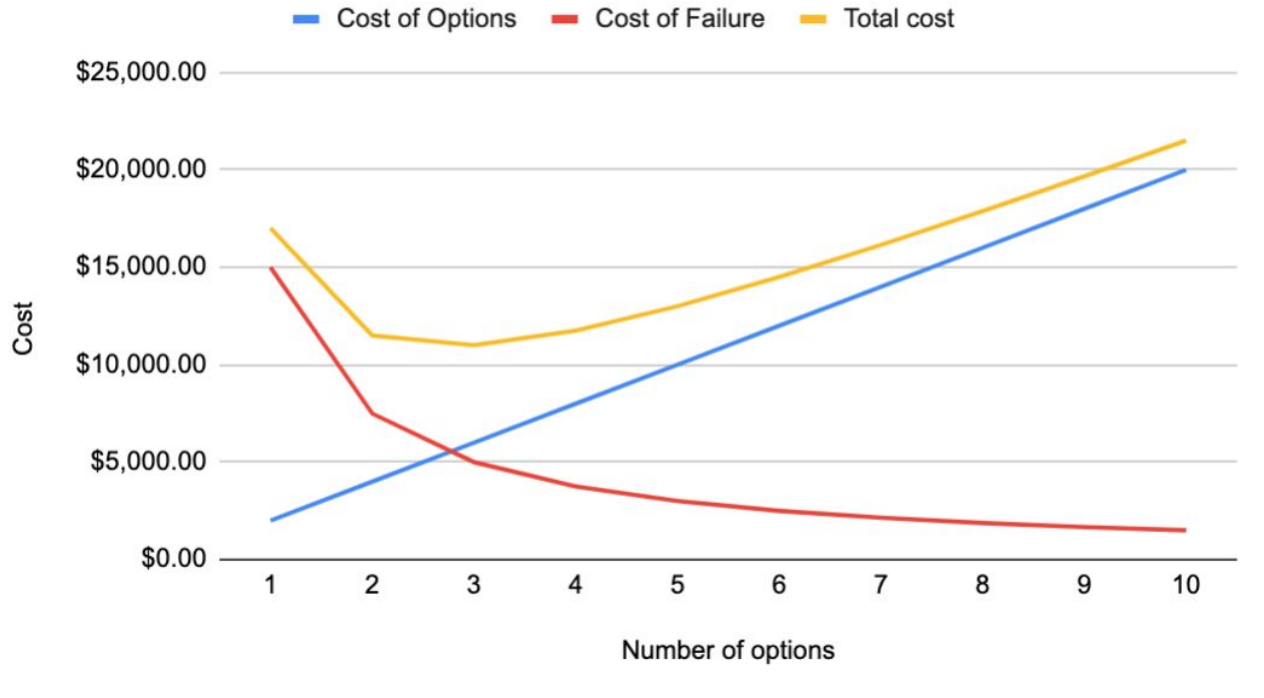
Maintain Options - Context Changes Quickly

Let's Play A Game

The Principle of Buying Information: The value of information is its expected economic value

How Many Options?

U-curve - Parallel Paths



Reversible Decisions



...the last responsible moment, that is, the moment at which failing to make a decision eliminates an important alternative.

- Mary & Tom Poppendieck , *Lean Software Development*, p.50

Context Changes

Right Today Can Be Wrong Tomorrow

Do your future self a favor

Study The System...

Favor decisions today that
give you better choices tomorrow
to steer your strategy into the future.

What Questions Do You Have?

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Thank you!

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